

commUni

Business Case Study

KEY RESOURCES · CHANNELS · RELATIONSHIPS · REVENUE · COSTS

What we need to *make it work*

1

Technology

Tech we need to run our app

- The app and its software
- Servers & cloud storage
- Search & matching features
- Data protection & security

2

People

Skills to develop & manage the app

- App developers
- UI / UX designers
- Marketing & social media specialists
- Knowledge of students' needs

3

Community

Our users and the content they share

- Active students from different universities
- Shared study notes & learning materials
- Shared-flat (WG) listings & housing profiles

4

Brand Identity

What makes us recognisable

- App name & logo
- Unique app features & design

Network effect: more users mean more content and more connections – the community is our most valuable resource.

5 · Financial resources: funding for development, launch and the first years of operation – see *Cost Structure*.

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Social media: *where students already are*

Youth channels – ranked by priority

Ads and influencer content on

1	TikTok	Influencers who happen to be students
2	Pinterest	Aesthetic study & living inspiration
3	Instagram	Influencers who happen to be students

“Student influencers show commUni as part of their daily life.”

They use it to structure, optimise and simplify their days at university – in the most aesthetic way possible.

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Campus, word of mouth *& web*

U

Universities

Direct access to new students

- Cooperation with universities
- App is introduced during welcome weeks
- Posters on campus and ads on university websites

S

Students themselves

Word of mouth & referrals

- Students tell their friends and family
- Little treats, e.g. a free event ticket for shared welcome links and registrations

W

Websites

First point of contact online

- App Store & Google Play listing
- Our own website to give a first insight

Five ways we *build loyalty*

For commUni it is important to build a strong relationship with our users and keep them interested in the app.

1

Community exchange & networking

Students connect with others who share similar interests – e.g. study groups or sports clubs.

2

Personalised recommendations

Every student has different needs, so we show relevant content: shared flats, second-hand furniture, tutoring offers.

3

Digital service & feedback

Users get help directly in the app and give feedback that helps us improve commUni.

4

Trust & safety

Moderation keeps the platform safe – especially when students look for flats or trade items with strangers.

5

User loyalty

Relevant content, regular updates and helpful reminders keep students coming back.

We want our users to feel *connected*, *understood* and *safe*.

This helps us build long-term relationships with our community.

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How commUni *earns money*

1

Ads & sponsored posts

Brands pay us to show student-specific ads in our app.

Fashion · Lifestyle · Fitness · Cafés & stores

2

Sponsored placement

People who offer their flat or products can pay to be seen by more users.

3

Events & meet-ups

Revenue from events and community meetings.

5 € per person

4

Paid cooperations

Partnerships with universities and student-lifestyle brands.

5

Commission

Earned through partner links and successful sales.

Free for students – financed by brands, partners and the community.

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One-time costs: *building & launching*

1

Development & Design

Complex app
≈ 1,600 hrs development time × 100 €/h

≈ 160k €

Largest single cost item

2

Founding

GmbH formation	≈ 1k €
Share capital (equity)	25k €
GDPR / data protection	≈ 2k €

Share capital is equity, not an expense.

3

Branding & Launch

Logo & branding	500 – 3,000 €
Google Play Store	25 € once
Apple App Store	99 € / year
Website launch	incl.

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Running costs: *operating the app*

Hosting & Maintenance

Hosting ~10,000 users at start	50 – 200 € / month
Maintenance 15–20 % of dev. cost	24 – 32k €

Marketing

Cost per install (CPI)	5 – 8.50 €
10,000 downloads	< 85k €

Personnel

Median manager 3.2k € gross + 20 % employer share	≈ 50k € / year
Working students for services	15 – 18 € / hour

Tools & Fees

Tools Figma, Adobe, Claude …	300 – 1,000 €
Store commission Google & Apple, revenue < 1m €/yr	15 %

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Total cost *at a glance*

YEAR 1 · BUILD & LAUNCH

135 – 300k €

Development, founding, branding, initial marketing, personnel and running costs.

YEAR 2 · OPERATE & GROW

80 – 120k €

No more one-time development costs – mainly maintenance, hosting, marketing and personnel.

Thank *you*

Questions & discussion

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